

REGISTER #24 STAGE: UNDER REVIEW CONFIDENCE: LOW REVIEW: AUG 8, 2026 AS OF JUL 24, 2026

Build the platform capability in-house, or buy the vendor?

DECISION OWNER ENGINEERING LEAD	APPROVER FOUNDER	ESCALATION FOUNDER	CATEGORY BUILD OR BUY
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WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS — EVERY CLAIM CITED OR MARKED

Engineering told leadership 'one quarter' (June 30 sync notes).

“One quarter to build it properly with the current team.”

m06-028 · ENGINEERING LEAD · LEADERSHIP SYNC NOTES · JUN 30

The same team in its own channel, July 11: 'realistically two quarters with current commitments.'

“Realistically two quarters with current commitments.”

m07-007 · SENIOR ENGINEER · #PLATFORM · JUL 11

The two estimates have never been in the same room.

DETECTED ABSENCE

The two estimates have never appeared in the same thread, document, or meeting. Verified across both channels.

The build plan also assumes the VP Engineering hire has closed (register #22).

“All estimates assume the VP Engineering seat is filled by August. (Register #22: still under review.)”

m04-006 · BUILD PLAN (REGISTER #19) · APR 9

CONTRADICTION ON THE RECORD

“One quarter to build it properly.” LEADERSHIP SYNC · JUN 30	“Realistically two quarters with current commitments.” #PLATFORM · JUL 11
Same team, eleven days apart, two audiences — two different answers.	

WHAT HAPPENED LAST TIME

- Two prior builds this size in the register — both shipped at roughly double the estimate.
- The one comparable buy is the billing vendor the team still routes around today (register #14).

“The two prior builds this size shipped at 1.9x and 2.2x of estimate. The billing vendor (register #14) has been live 14 months; the team still routes around it.”

REGISTERS #10, #13, #14 · OUTCOME NOTES

WHAT'S MISSING

- Security has not appeared in any thread about this vendor — and on May 12, leadership decided no new vendor touches customer data until SOC 2 closes.
- Nobody in this thread has mentioned it.
- This vendor would touch customer data.

“No new vendor touches customer data until SOC 2 closes.”

REGISTER #16 · LEADERSHIP MINUTES · MAY 12

RECOMMENDATION

This isn't build-vs-buy yet. It's whether the May 12 decision still stands. Decide that first — if it stands, buy is blocked until Q4 at any price, and the real question is what the two-quarter build displaces.

'Two quarters' includes the September launch freeze. Appended to m07-007.

CORRECTION · JUL 12 · ENGINEERING LEAD · APPEND-ONLY, ATTRIBUTED

How to read this brief: every claim above traces to a quoted source message (message ID · role · channel · date), to a register entry, or is explicitly marked as inference or detected absence. Nothing is smoothed over. This document is illustrative — one shared fictional company, people shown as roles — and contains no customer data. In a pilot, this brief is built from your own exported conversations.

ILLUSTRATIVE · NOT CUSTOMER DATA · ONE SHARED FICTIONAL COMPANY, ROLES ONLY

ANTHRIE · SAMPLE DECISION BRIEF